

Heart and Lung Sound Clues

Use location, timing, quality, symmetry, symptoms, and trend together.

Heart landmarks - S1 marks closure at the start of systole; S2 marks closure at the end. - Extra sounds or murmurs require context and trained assessment. - Apical rate and rhythm help verify an irregular peripheral pulse.	Lung landmarks - Crackles: discontinuous popping, often linked with fluid or reopening airways. - Wheezes: musical narrowing clue. - Stridor: upper-airway emergency clue. - Diminished/absent: consider poor air movement, obstruction, or other urgent causes.
Assess before naming - Compare side to side. - Note work of breathing, speech, color, cough, and oxygen data. - Escalate acute asymmetry, stridor, silence with distress, or rapid deterioration.	